







DESIGN DISCOURSE

An insider's look at Design POV 2026, where Asif Sataar and Gagan Bhatia transformed a typical trade show into an open, intellectual playground

BUREAU REPORT

Every trade show has an unprogrammed ghost schedule unfolding in the margins—between panels and rushed espressos. For co-founders Asif Sataar and Gagan Bhatia, this was just the starting point. Returning to Mumbai's Jio World Convention Centre, Design POV '26 is the definitive antidote to transactional expos. Under the theme Sense & Sensibility, the platform hosted 16 studios and 80+ brands. By trading static displays for unfiltered, lived experiences, Design POV proved that the industry's best insights happen when you step completely outside the system.

Redefining the Form

"Design POV began by listening to the honest exchanges happening outside exhibition halls, where networking isn't mechanical," reflects Gagan. To break this performative cycle, the co-founders rejected standard, risk-averse expo blueprints. "We weren't trying to improve the system; we were stepping outside it," explains Asif. While Gagan manages commercial scale, Asif anchors the conceptual rigour. This partnership democratised access to a legacy market that usually rewards insular networks. Design POV '26 also proved that raw curiosity and flawless execution—not mere privilege—should dictate industry opportunity.